Northstar Knowledge Assistant

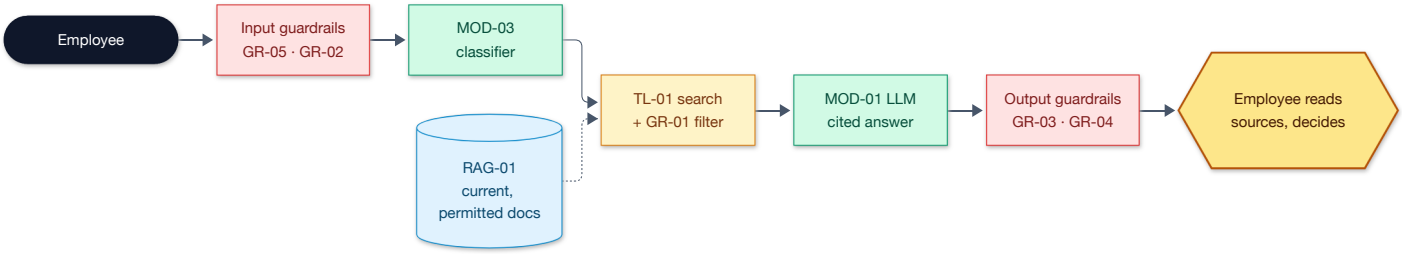
Owner: Head of People Operations · **Version:** 1.0 · **Date:** 2026-11-04-17-00-00 UTC · Example 1 of 4 (illustrative numbers)

1. Problem

> **Northstar employees** struggle to **find the current rule or procedure** because **policies and manuals exist in conflicting, outdated versions**, resulting in **≈ 540 h a month (€21.6k) lost searching and 22 % of answers based on a superseded document.**

Scope: internal Q&A over HR policies, product manuals and procedures. **Non-goals:** changing policies, personal records, any write action.

2. Solution: cited answers from current sources only, or an honest "I don't know"



Component	Used for	Catalog ID
RAG index (hybrid, version + access metadata)	Current, permitted evidence only	RAG-01
Tools (read-only)	Search, exact excerpt, version diff	TL-01, TL-02, TL-03
Models	Classifier routes; LLM writes the cited answer	MOD-03, MOD-01
Workflow	Classify → filter → retrieve → answer → validate	WF-01, WF-02

#	Use case	Target user	Priority
UC1	Policy Q&A, version-aware	Employee	★ riskiest
UC2	Product troubleshooting lookup	Support analyst	High
UC3	Policy change comparison	Content owner	Medium
UC4	Abstention and gap report	Employee → content owner	High

3. Risks and guards

Risk	Guard
Stale policy stated as current	`GR-01` effective-date filter in code; version fixtures at 100 % (`EV-04`)
Invented or unsupported answer	`GR-03` : every claim must cite a retrieved chunk ID; `GR-04` abstains below τ
Unauthorised document exposed	`GR-01` access-group filter before retrieval; 100 % on auth fixtures

Key assumption: document version and date metadata is correct. Ingestion (`WF-03`) rejects documents that lack it.

4. Evals

Measure	Metric	Baseline → target / threshold
Value	Time to a trusted answer	18 min → ≤ 3 min
Quality	Retrieval recall@5 · citation validity · correct abstention	≥ 85 % · ≥ 90 % · ≥ 90 %
Adoption	Questions answered through the assistant	0 % → ≥ 60 %

Evidence so far: the prototype passes the version and abstention fixtures on a 40-question gold set. Time saved and adoption are still hypotheses. **Decision asked:** the **COO** approves a **6-week pilot** (120 users, ≈ €18k) by **2026-11-30-17-00-00 UTC**.